Women's Policy [1]

The Green Party will prioritise Papatūānuku and foster harmony between communities, the economy, and nature. The Greens will create an equitable and inclusive leadership landscape, including for wāhine Māori. The Greens will protect women and girls from harm at home, at work, in the community, and online, and strive for gender equity in all areas and at all times.

Vision

Women thrive, lead, and uplift our communities, and our connection to Papatūānuku is honoured.

Values and Principles

"He wāhine, he whenua, e ngaro ai te tangata"[2]

- *Kaitiakitanga* - Women often play nurturing and leadership roles in maintaining the balance between people and nature. Papatūānuku, as whenua and nurturer, must herself be nourished.
- *Mana wāhine* - Women's dignity must be upheld and our collective wisdom respected.
- *Manahau* - Women's collective wellbeing and vitality must be supported. Addressing the intergenerational impact of colonisation on wāhine Māori is a priority.
- *Mana motuhake* - Women's right to self-determination must be protected and realised and equitable opportunities provided. Women must have agency at all levels and our voices must be heard. The tino rangatiratanga of wāhine Māori must be honoured.
- *Manaakitanga* - Women must be safe from discrimination and gender-based violence.
- *Whanaungatanga* - Women's wellbeing and that of our whānau and community are interdependent. Our heart relationships must be supported, as individuals, as a collective, and with other species.
- *Kotahitanga* - The interconnected and intersectional nature of women's experiences across diverse backgrounds and identities must be recognised. We stand in solidarity with all oppressed genders.

Strategic Priorities

The Green Party's strategic goals include:

"A more connected, compassionate, and equal Aotearoa"

[1] In this policy, "we" refers to *women*: Self-identified females, encompassing diverse biological, social, and cultural identities, experiences, and expressions of femininity and womanhood. This includes transgender women, intersex women, and anyone politically considered 'a woman' due to their presentation or sex assigned at birth.

[2] This whakatauki means, among other translations: without the nourishment wāhine give (the whenua referring to both Papatūānuku nourishing us and the placenta nourishing our pēpī), humanity would be lost.

Actions in this policy that will help achieve this include:

- Resourcing the circular economy and women's roles in it. (1.1.1)
- Resourcing and enacting recommendations by the Ministry for Women and Mana Wāhine Kaupapa Inquiry (WAI2700). (2.1.2; 3.2.1)
- Supporting fair pay measures and increasing the minimum wage to a living wage. (3.4.1)
- Resourcing violence prevention, response, and refuge services that are culturally safe and accessible to all. (4.1.1)
- Legally recognising and supporting informal caregivers as part of the care system. (5.1.1)
- Providing equitable arts funding to support and protect arts practised by women from Māori, Pacific, and marginalised communities. (6.2.2)

Policy Positions

1. Kaitiakitanga

Issues

Many people have become disconnected from Papatūānuku, whenua and nurturer, an illusion of separation that is enabled by advancing technologies. Colonisation imposed a patriarchal worldview of domination over nature, suppressing cultures like te ao Māori that recognise interconnection, and distancing people—by force or urbanisation—from the land of their ancestors. This disconnection both enables and hides from view the damage to people and planet that our industrial society is causing.

Actions

1.1. Prioritise Papatūānuku and foster harmony between communities, the economy, and nature, through holistic practices rooted in Māori values, including by:

1.1.1. Resourcing the circular economy and women's roles in it;

1.1.2. Regenerating nature close to social spaces; and

1.1.3. Removing barriers to Māori connecting to their traditional whenua, including seeking to return it to Māori ownership.

1.2. Support nature-based approaches to wellbeing, including by:

1.2.1. Advancing soil and food sovereignty;

1.2.2. Enabling access to rongoā Māori services; and

1.2.3. Resourcing whānau, hapū and other community-led initiatives.

See also our Biodiversity and Environmental Regeneration Policy, Waste and Hazardous Substances Policy, Land Use and Soils Policy, Freshwater Policy, Marine Policy, and Food Policy.

2. Mana Wāhine and Manahau

Issues

The mana of women has been overlooked and omitted from government systems, due to the process of colonisation, and despite decades of feminist activism. This sexism has led to anti-democratic views, the minimisation of women's contributions in the workforce as well as in communities and whānau, with associated economic inequality and productivity loss. There is

violence against women and other marginalised genders. Current pushback against equality is often linked to rising fundamentalist ideologies, authoritarianism, and neoliberalism. There is a growing divide between young men vs young women and those of other marginalised genders, in their attitudes towards gender equality.

Actions

2.1. Provide equitable public services, including health, education, justice, and housing, including by:

2.1.1. Tailoring public services to women, in consultation with Rainbow, disability, Pasifika, and ethnic women's experts; and

2.1.2. Resourcing and enacting recommendations by the Ministry for Women.

2.2. Ensure that employment conditions meet the needs of women, including by:

2.2.1. Preventing workplace discrimination;

2.2.2. Facilitating gender-based collective bargaining processes; and

2.2.3. Advance education and workplace opportunities for Māori, Pasifika, migrant and ethnic, disabled, and rainbow women.

2.3. Ensure that all women undertaking sex work are doing so safely and willingly, including by:

2.3.1. Regulating sex work under civil law and including temporary migrant sex workers in that protection;

2.3.2. Increasing research into identifying and effectively responding to domestic sex trafficking and survival sex, including gang and intrafamilial links; and

2.3.3. Resource an independent national helpline, and other specific supports and services for victim-survivors of sex trafficking of all genders, run by people with lived experience.

2.4. Ensure equitable responses to environmental and social crises, including the climate crisis, including by:

2.4.1. Building community resilience and adapting to predicted changes;

2.4.2. Prioritising female-dominated work in Just Transition policy, initiatives, and funding;

2.4.3. Incorporating women's knowledge into crisis response, especially that of indigenous women, in a way that is respectful, responsible and empowering; and

2.4.4. Challenging patriarchal and colonial scientific norms and methods.

2.5. Uphold cultural rights for women, including by:

2.5.1. Amending laws that sustain harmful gender stereotypes;

2.5.2. Upholding women's right to question institutional, community or religious norms that perpetuate women's subordination; and

2.5.3. Providing equitable support for women in the arts, sports, and sciences.

See also our Workforce Policy, Emergency Management Policy, Climate Change Policy, Recreation and Sport Policy, and Research, Science and Technology Policy

3. Mana Motuhake

Issues

Gender disparities persist in leadership roles with wahine Māori, Pasifika women, and women in other marginalised groups particularly under-represented. Wāhine Māori, in particular, have suffered from the effects of colonisation and inter-generational violence and trauma which has undermined their and whānau wellbeing, leadership, spirituality, knowledge, and rights, including the loss of moko kauae. This is ongoing as wāhine Māori are often ignored and unacknowledged by the Crown and others.

Women frequently face challenges in achieving pay parity with their male counterparts. Women-dominated industries tend to receive lower pay, and women are more likely to work part-time or take career breaks due to caregiving responsibilities. For women of Māori and Pasifika heritage, the disparity is even more pronounced. Lower earnings for women are reflected in lower savings for retirement and weaker economic resilience of families.

Actions

3.1. Create an equitable and inclusive leadership landscape, including by:

- 3.1.1. Resourcing collectives, mentoring, and other programmes that support women, especially marginalised women, to be leaders;
- 3.1.2. Supporting Tiriti-based governance and constitutional transformation; and
- 3.1.3. Implementing recommendations to uphold the UN Convention of Elimination of all forms of Discrimination Against Women.

3.2. Support wāhine Māori in their continued leadership for their whenua, whānau wellbeing, mana motuhake, and tino rangatiratanga, including by:

- 3.2.1. Enacting recommendations from the Mana Wāhine Kaupapa Inquiry;
- 3.2.2. Removing barriers to appointing wāhine Māori staff, especially in leadership roles; and
- 3.2.3. Resourcing hapū and wāhine Māori organisations to create te ao Māori systems and services, run by women for women.

3.3. Address gender inequities in wealth, including by:

- 3.3.1. Implementing taxes on wealth; and
- 3.3.2. Providing additional support to women to save for retirement.

3.4. Address gender inequities in income, including by:

- 3.4.1. Supporting fair pay measures and increasing the minimum wage to a living wage;
- 3.4.2. Offering tax relief for low-income households; and
- 3.4.3. Providing accessible, equitable, and respectful income support services.

3.5. Uphold women's reproductive rights, including by:

- 3.5.1. Ensuring equitable access for all relevant people to contraception, abortion, fertility treatments, and obstetric and gynaecological specialists.

See also our Governance Policy, Human Rights Policy, Government in the Economy Policy, Livelihoods Policy, and Health Policy.

4. Manaakitanga

Issues

Workplace discrimination, the gender pay gap, digital harm, and microaggressions are persistent common problems. For women who experience multiple forms of discrimination—including based on age, class, disability, race, ethnicity, sexual orientation, gender identity, or migration status—the obstacles to equality are even greater. Too many vulnerable women and their children are trapped in violent situations, often at home.

Actions

4.1. Eliminate family and sexual violence, including by:

- 4.1.1. Resourcing violence prevention, response, and refuge services that are culturally safe and accessible to all;
- 4.1.2. Educating all young people about consent, sexuality, and wellbeing in relationships; and
- 4.1.3. Addressing mental health issues connected to family and sexual violence.

4.2. Support homeless women and their children, including by:

- 4.2.1. Taking a housing-first approach, with wrap-around support for women in all situations, including single older women; and
- 4.2.2. Providing employment, education, and financial assistance appropriate for hard-to-reach communities.

4.3. Protect migrant and refugee women and girls, including by:

- 4.3.1. Enabling women to settle independently from their partner, if desired;
- 4.3.2. Ensuring settlement centres and services are safe and culturally responsive;
- 4.3.3. Facilitating social networks and communication for new migrants; and
- 4.3.4. Protecting girls' rights relating to female genital mutilation in sexual health education programmes.

4.4. Protect women and girls from digital harm, including women in public positions, including by:

- 4.4.1. Regulating social media and other online content providers;
- 4.4.2. Resourcing online harm prevention and responses that are tailored to girls' needs; and
- 4.4.3. Resourcing programmes for all genders that improve empathy, emotional intelligence, and communication.

4.5. Protect the rights of queer and trans women to access resources available to other women, including by:

- 4.5.1. Providing information and access to gender affirming care for queer and trans women;
- 4.5.2. Supporting trans refugees and migrants; and
- 4.5.3. Ensuring that emergency accommodation is available for queer and trans women in all situations.

See also our Justice Policy, Education Policy, Drug Law Reform Policy, Housing and Sustainable Communities Policy, Immigration Policy, Digital Policy, and Rainbow Policy.

5. Whanaungatanga

Issues

Women often play an important caregiving role in our families and communities. In our current economic system, this too often costs us time and money that we cannot afford and impacts employment opportunities.

Interruptions to our relationships can cause harm that echoes across generations. For example, there is a well-established pathway from colonisation to state care to gangs and/or prison, with no clear pathway out.

Actions

5.1. Enable women to care for themselves and their dependents, including by:

- 5.1.1. Legally recognising and supporting informal caregivers as part of the care system;
- 5.1.2. Taking caring roles into account when providing leave from work;
- 5.1.3. Providing comprehensive, appropriate support services for pregnant people; and
- 5.1.4. Covering all birthing injuries to parents and babies under ACC.

5.2. Uphold the value and wellbeing of mothers as a "circuit breaker" preventing intergenerational harm, including by:

- 5.2.1. Expanding programmes that prioritise wellbeing for women in rural, gang and other "hard-to-reach" communities;
- 5.2.2. Reforming the justice system to prioritise restorative, trauma-informed approaches and maintain whānau connections; and
- 5.2.3. Support whānau- and community-led care for at-risk children.

See also our Accident Compensation Policy, Children's Policy, and Youth Policy.

6. Kotahitanga

Issues

New Zealand's feminist movements have historically centered Pākehā (white) women, but some women face compounded inequities, including Māori, Pasifika, migrant, disabled, and queer women.

Actions

6.1. Ensure that policies supporting women centre wāhine Māori and the most marginalised women, including by:

- 6.1.1. Respecting that trans women are women and upholding their rights;
- 6.1.2. Requiring all policy decision-making that affects marginalised women be made with our direct participation and leadership; and
- 6.1.3. Supporting organisations that recognise and respond to intersectionality.

6.2. Promote women's art as a tool for community health, social cohesion and environmental benefit, including by:

6.2.1. Supporting the financial sustainability of creative careers;

6.2.2. Providing equitable arts funding to support and protect arts practised by women from Māori, Pacific, and marginalised communities; and

6.2.3. Supporting women who are artists, writers, and cultural leaders to provide diverse gender narratives.

6.3. Support media to elevate the stories of women, including by:

6.3.1. Incentivising media platforms to counter harmful gender stereotypes and celebrate diverse women; and

6.3.2. Monitoring and reporting on the representation of women in national media platforms.

See also our Kaupapa Māori Policy, Arts, Culture and Heritage Policy, and Media Policy.